Where do we start with AI rules?

Business: Example Electrical Ltd Date: 23 October 2026

Sources checked: 19 October 2026

A sound start; two or three steps are open.

AI tools are not in use as far as you know. There are no written rules. The team has not been briefed. First step: Write the usage policy: nine areas, signed by the management, with the one page to post.

What you told us

AI in use	No, as far as we know
Kinds of tools	Translation tools
Personal data in tools	No
Written rules	No
Briefing	No
Published AI output	No
Decisions about people	No

Where you stand

Business accounts, training on inputs off, tool register — PARTLY
Nothing in use yet; decide before the first tool arrives.

Written usage policy with the one page to post — OPEN
Missing.

Briefing with record (Article 4 AI Act) — OPEN
Not yet.

Labelling check (Article 50 AI Act) — REGULATED
No case at present; record it with a date.

Decisions about people kept out — REGULATED
Excluded; write it into the policy.

Findings

■ FACT Article 4(1) of the AI Act asks providers and deployers to take measures to support the development of AI literacy of their staff and of other persons dealing with the operation and use of AI systems on their behalf, taking into account their knowledge, experience, education and the context of use; it does not require guaranteeing any specific level for any individual. The article has applied since 2 February 2025. The Commission writes that no certificate is needed and that organisations can keep an internal record of trainings.

→ Regulation (EU) 2024/1689, Art. 4(1) and Art. 113, point (a), consolidated version of 27 July 2026 · EUR-Lex · retrieved 2026-10-19; European Commission, AI literacy, questions and answers, page dated 27 July 2026 · retrieved 2026-10-18

◆ INTERPRETATION Neither the AI Act nor the GDPR contains a provision that explicitly requires a written AI usage policy. Article 4 asks for measures that support literacy, Article 24(1) GDPR asks the controller for technical and organisational measures that are reviewed and updated, and the Trade Secrets Directive protects information only if reasonable steps were taken to keep it secret. A policy is the usual way to meet all three at once, not a duty of its own.

→ Regulation (EU) 2024/1689, Art. 4; Regulation (EU) 2016/679, Art. 24(1); Directive (EU) 2016/943, Art. 2(1), point (c) · retrieved 2026-10-18 and 2026-10-19

◌ GAP How often a briefing is repeated and how long its record is kept is stated in no source we read. A new or changed tool is an obvious occasion to repeat; the business sets the rhythm.

◐ UNCERTAIN Which authority supervises Articles 4 and 50 is national law. Germany has named the Federal Network Agency (Act of 22 July 2026, in force since 29 July 2026). For Austria, as of 19 October 2026, no official source names the market surveillance authority; the duties apply regardless.

→ KI-Marktüberwachungs- und Innovationsförderungsgesetz of 22 July 2026, BGBl. 2026 I No. 223, § 2(1) · gesetze-im-internet.de · retrieved 2026-10-19; Datenschutzbehörde (Austria), page on artificial intelligence and data protection · dsb.gv.at · retrieved 2026-10-19

What to do next

- [ ] Keep the tool register current: one row per tool, training on inputs off, the processor contract filed where personal data is involved.
- [ ] Write the usage policy in nine areas: permitted tools and accounts, permitted and prohibited uses, what never goes in, handling unavoidable personal data, review before use, release of documents leaving the business, labelling, reporting incidents, responsibility in case of doubt. Post the one page.

- [ ] Brief the team: the policy section by section, what never goes in, two or three use cases from the business, the failure patterns, the reporting channel. Keep the attendance list with date and contents.
- [ ] Record "no labelling case at present" with a date, and ask again when AI output starts to reach customers or the public.
- [ ] Freeze an evidence page with the date: what is regulated, what is open, who is responsible, when it is reviewed next.

The AI Policy Toolkit does steps 2 to 5 from thirty-one questions: the usage policy, the one page to post, the tool register with approval form, the briefing record, the labelling checklist, the enactment plan and the evidence summary, with a handbook that marks every statement.

Sources

1. Regulation (EU) 2024/1689 of 13 June 2024 (AI Act), consolidated version of 27 July 2026: Art. 4, Art. 5(1)(f), Art. 26(2), Art. 50, Art. 113, Annex III point 4. eur-lex.europa.eu · retrieved 2026-10-19.
2. Regulation (EU) 2026/1744 of 8 July 2026 (Digital Omnibus on AI), in force since 27 July 2026: Art. 1, points (5), (39) and (40). eur-lex.europa.eu/eli/reg/2026/1744/oj · retrieved 2026-10-18.
3. Regulation (EU) 2016/679 (GDPR), consolidated version of 4 May 2016: Art. 24(1), Art. 28(1) and (3), Art. 32(1). eur-lex.europa.eu · retrieved 2026-10-19.
4. Directive (EU) 2016/943 on the protection of trade secrets: Art. 2(1)©. eur-lex.europa.eu · retrieved 2026-10-18.
5. European Commission, AI literacy, questions and answers, page dated 27 July 2026. digital-strategy.ec.europa.eu/en/faqs/ai-literacy-questions-answers · retrieved 2026-10-18. Guidance, not law.
6. European Commission, Guidelines on the transparency obligations under Article 50, C(2026) 5054 final of 20 July 2026, point 131. digital-strategy.ec.europa.eu · retrieved 2026-10-19. Guidance, not law.
7. Datenschutzkonferenz (German data protection authorities), Orientierungshilfe "Künstliche Intelligenz und Datenschutz", version 1.0 of 6 May 2024, sections 1.9, 2.2, 2.4, 2.5, 3.1. datenschutzkonferenz-online.de · retrieved 2026-10-18. Guidance, not law.
8. Germany: KI-Marktüberwachungs- und Innovationsförderungsgesetz of 22 July 2026, BGBl. 2026 I No. 223, § 2(1). gesetze-im-internet.de · retrieved 2026-10-19. Austria: Datenschutzbehörde, page on artificial intelligence and data protection, undated. dsb.gv.at · retrieved 2026-10-19.

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